Cowabunga SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

FRI OCT 16, 2026 DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · FRI OCT 16 · NORTH PB

Smaller swell, longer tide window. Little Point before the NE gusts.

the S swell is still clean: paddle out by 7:00

PADDLE OUT BY	7:00	BOARD Inferno 72 ~70°F WATER

GAME PLAN · MAKE THE MOST OF IT

Little Point

WINDOW	7–10:30a · Inferno 72 · ~70°F
SURF	3–5 ft (SRF)
TIDE	L 0.8 @ 7:37p Thu H 4.7 @ 12:08p L 1.0 @ 8:59p obs 4.3 @ 6:48a

A lower high buys you time.

7 /10

SURF RATING · GOOD · LIVE

Good — worth rearranging your morning

capped by swell 2.6 ft · Better than 33% of 33 logged PB/La Jolla mornings since 09/12

What's in the water

3–5 FT (SRF)

GROUND

SwH 2.6 ft · 15s

WINDSWELL

WWH 1.3 ft · 10s

HS BUOY

Hs 3.0 ft · 46258



FROM

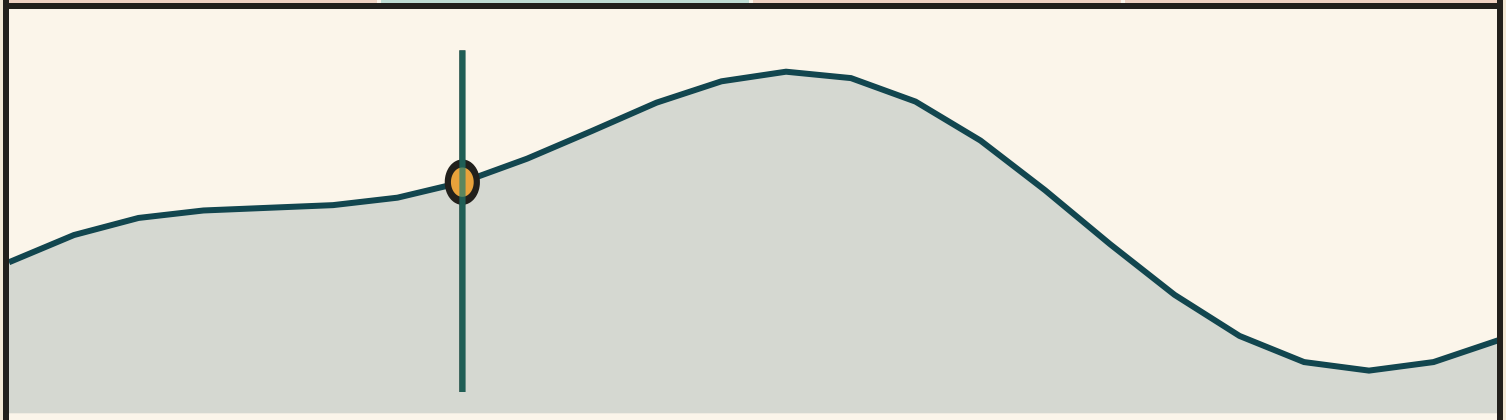
199° SSW

Buoy 46258 spectrum · ground 2.6 ft @ 15s SSW (13–15s overnight) + WWH 1.3 ft @ 10s · face 3–5 ft (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 SW 3 ft @ 14s + NW 4 ft @ 12s · MWD 199° SSW · wind light NNE/E early, NE building

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

PRE-7A · FIRST LIGHT	7–10:30A · LITTLE POINT	10:45A–2P HIGH / NE	AFTERNOON DRAIN
WAIT	GO	SKIP	SKIP



7:00a	GO · Little Point	3.3 ft tide	N ~4 kt · NWS	3–5 ft (SRF)

L 0.8 @ 7:37p Thu · H 4.7 @ 12:08p · L 1.0 @ 8:59p · obs 4.3 @ 6:48a

Little Point, 7 to about 10:30a, on the Inferno 72. No morning low — the tide has been rising slowly since last night's 0.8 ft low toward H 4.7 @ 12:08p. The gauge read 4.33 ft at 6:48a against about 3.2 predicted, so it is still running roughly 1.1 ft over the table. That puts the reef past its 5.5 ft ceiling around 10:30a (later than yesterday's 9:15a because today's table high is only 4.7). Pier anemometers overnight: NNE 5–7 kt with a soft SE/E turn near 6a (LJAC1 SE 5 kt @ 6:00a). NWS hourly holds N 5 mph through 8a, then N/NE/E 10 mph from 9a as the Santa Ana heat builds toward the mid-80s. No good afternoon backup: high tide under NE wind, then a long drain to L 1.0 @ 8:59p after sunset. Sunrise 6:52a, sunset 6:16p.

Where it's working

★ Little Point

Top of the scorecard at 0.98. SSW groundswell (46258 SwH 2.6 ft @ 15s, MWD 192–211° overnight) still fits the reef, and the tide is rising slowly toward a milder 4.7 ft noon high. The gauge read 4.33 ft at 6:48a, about 1.1 ft over the table, so the reef reaches its 5.5 ft ceiling around 10:30a — later than yesterday. Pier wind has been NNE to E overnight with a soft SE turn at 6a; NWS holds N 5 mph through 8a before NE/E 10 mph from 9a. Paddle out by 7:00.

CALL

2 **PB Drive**
Score 0.94. Also fine on the same light early wind if Little Point is packed. Softer sandbar peaks on a thinner 2.6 ft groundswell — Anvil territory if you land here.

ALSO

3 **Calumet**
Score 0.85. Good swell angle, but already flagged tide-high vs its lower window on this rising flood. Pass.

SOFT

4 **Tourmaline**
Score 0.83. Rideable, but fuller than you want as the tide pushes toward the 12:08p high.

SOFT

5 **PB north of the pier**
Score 0.72. SSW mostly misses the pier wedge; PZZ740 also lists a NW 4 ft @ 12s component that may help later, but dawn still favors the south-facing reefs.

SOFT

• Skip · PB Point (0.41) is undersized and too full on thin groundswell. The Cliffs (Garbage, Abs, Luscomb's) want W groundswell and a lower tide — today is SSW on a flooding mid–high. OB same story. Scripps and Blacks are extended only and do not top a local reef on light offshore SSW.

SKIP

BOARD

Inferno 72

~70°F

QUIVER

Sharp Eye Inferno 72

Clean 15-second groundswell on a steep reef left with light early offshore. Smaller than yesterday, but still Inferno territory at Little Point — not mushy sandbar.

Anvil twin · if you end up on the Drive sandbar
TW log · too much push for it today

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

A lower high buys you time.

Yesterday the table high was 5.1 ft and Little Point topped out near 9:15a. Today the high is only 4.7 ft at noon, so even with the gauge still running about a foot over the table, the reef stays in its 3.0–5.5 ft band almost an hour longer. Same anomaly, slower climb — that is free morning.

SKIP

Little Point after about 10:30a, when the tide anomaly crosses the 5.5 ft ceiling and NE gusts fill. Everything from late morning through the noon high. Calumet, Tourmo, and PB Point on this flood. The Cliffs and OB on a SSW primary swell.

GOTCHAS

Little Point is a shallow reef with a tight takeoff, so it crowds fast and the rocks show as it drains. High rip current risk today (NWS SRF). Sets at 15 seconds mean long lulls, then a solid set. Heat is back — NWS grid tops near 89°F with NE wind, so bring water for the stairs at Fern Glen. PZZ740 has NE 10–15 kt with gusts to 20 in the marine zone; the beach may stay lighter early, but do not wait for midday.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL: Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES